acute financially struggling years of my college years, several friends, in particular Sunil Saxena, helped me to earn and get the minimum required financial resources to meet my expenditures and family commitments.

The experience of implementing numerous programmes of poverty alleviation, promoting industrial and infrastructure enterprises in cooperative and public sectors, designing and monitoring redistribution programmes in education, health and renewables sectors, dealing with policy issues in agriculture, power, transport and finance sectors in the first fifteen years of my service in Rajasthan provided an immensely valuable foundation for my understanding of the vast Indian economy. During this period, several officers gave me opportunity and space, consciously or subconsciously, to try out unconventional approaches and make innovations. In particular, I would like to acknowledge contributions of C.S. Rajan, Priyadarshi Thakur, Rajiv Mehrishi, the late Dr Adarsh Kishore, the late M.L. Mehta and the late V.B.L. Mathur.

Dr E.A.S. Sarma initiated me to the Government of India in the year 2000 by inducting me as a director in the department of economic affairs. This proved to be a stepping stone for providing me the real opportunity to get into the economic and financial policymaking of the country. In the Government of India, I had an incredibly productive and satisfying time in a variety of departments—economic affairs, expenditure, agriculture, cabinet secretariat and Ministry of Power. Working in the Ministry of Finance gave me excellent access to understanding the policies and programmes of almost every department and organization of the government. I benefited from working with many secretaries and other senior officers. Many talented young officers and colleagues worked with me in these departments as well. Their notes, briefings and valuable contributions are gratefully acknowledged. My heartfelt thanks to all of them.

I returned twice to my cadre, Rajasthan, in 2006–2009 and 2014. Both times Vasundhara Raje used my services in the finance department. She